

UX Research Meets AI: Level Up Your Skills

Pongkhi Bujorbarua
Google
Seattle, Washington, USA
pongkhi@google.com

Rachana Ranade
Google
Sunnyvale, California, USA
rachana103@gmail.com

Abstract

This course will empower the attendees to confidently navigate the changing landscape of UX research. We will equip them with the foundational knowledge and practical skills to harness the power of AI while maintaining a human-centered approach. Attendees will learn how to a) ask the right questions and frame research objectives that get to the heart of user needs, with AI in the mix b) choose the best methods to master the research fundamentals to guide AI, avoid bias, and ensure meaningful results, and c) learn to level up the impact by translating AI-generated insights into actionable design decisions that truly improve the user experience.

ACM Reference Format:

Pongkhi Bujorbarua and Rachana Ranade. 2025. UX Research Meets AI: Level Up Your Skills. In *Extended Abstracts of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '25)*, April 26–May 01, 2025, Yokohama, Japan. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 2 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3706599.3706644>

1 Introduction

Discover the power of AI in UX research with this engaging course designed for new students, junior UX researchers (0-3 years of experience), UX designers, professionals transitioning into UX research, and product managers. Attendees will gain knowledge and hands-on skills to harness AI's potential in their work.

Attendees will benefit in the following ways:

- **Gain a Competitive Edge:** Master the latest AI-powered UX research techniques.
- **Enhance Skills:** Strengthen core research abilities and learn to critically evaluate AI-generated insights.
- **Boost Confidence:** Confidently navigate the AI revolution in UX research.
- **Strengthen Cross-functional Partnerships:** Learn effective communication strategies.

1.1 Module 1: Building a Strong Foundation (75 minutes)

Become a skilled UX researcher! Learn to navigate the complexities of the research process with confidence, mastering techniques for gathering meaningful insights from target audience and building stronger cross-functional partnerships along the way. We will equip you with the tools to define research objectives, select the most

Permission to make digital or hard copies of all or part of this work for personal or classroom use is granted without fee provided that copies are not made or distributed for profit or commercial advantage and that copies bear this notice and the full citation on the first page. Copyrights for third-party components of this work must be honored. For all other uses, contact the owner/author(s).

CHI EA '25, Yokohama, Japan

© 2025 Copyright held by the owner/author(s).

ACM ISBN 979-8-4007-1395-8/2025/04

<https://doi.org/10.1145/3706599.3706644>

effective methodologies, and transform raw data into actionable recommendations that shape exceptional user experiences.

Key Topics:

- Core Principles of UX Research: Prioritizing user needs and empathy-driven design.
- Stakeholder Engagement: Building relationships and communicating the value of UX research.
- Defining Research Objectives and Questions: Crafting clear objectives and identifying target audiences.
- Planning and Conducting Research Activities: Executing studies effectively and asking the right questions.
- Choosing the Right Research Methods: A primer on key UX research methodologies.
- Communicating Findings and Recommendations: Creating impactful reports and tailoring communication.

1.2 Module 2: Integrating AI into UX Research (75 minutes)

Unlock the future of UX research! Gain hands-on experience with leading AI tools like Gemini/ChatGPT and learn how to apply them to real-world research challenges. We will focus on crafting effective prompts, identifying potential biases in AI-generated outputs, and leveraging AI to gather deeper user insights.

Key Topics:

- Mastering the Art of Prompting: Guide AI tools effectively to generate relevant insights.
- Exploring AI-Powered UX Research Tools: Discover how AI can be used for sentiment analysis, automated transcription, and to identify key themes.
- Sharpening Critical Evaluation Skills: Assess AI-generated findings and identify potential biases.
- Integrating AI into your Workflow: Leverage AI strategically while maintaining a human-centered approach.

2 practical work during module 1 and module 2

There will be hands-on exercises for both module 1 and module 2.

2.1 Activity for Module 1

Hands-on Research Exercise: In this group activity, attendees will tackle a real-world scenario (e.g., a mobile banking app with low user engagement) to reinforce understanding of UX research principles in a real-world scenario. Below is a sample outline of our activity:

Steps:

- **Define Objectives:** Determine what needs to be learned to understand the problem.
- **Craft Questions:** Develop specific research questions to guide the objectives.

- **Choose Methods:** Select the best research methods (*interviews, surveys, etc.*) to answer the questions.
- **Present and Discuss:** Share findings and discuss alternative approaches with the larger group.

2.2 Activities for Module 2

Prompt Battle (Activity 1): Craft the perfect prompt to unlock the AI's full potential. Through multiple rounds of refinement, attendees will learn how subtle changes in wording can dramatically impact the AI's output.

Steps:

- **Initial Prompt:** Formulate an initial prompt to address the research question.
- **AI Response and Evaluation:** Input the prompt into the AI tool and analyze the generated output. Identify areas for improvement in terms of clarity, focus, or depth of insights.
- **Prompt Iteration:** Refine the initial prompt based on the evaluation. Experiment with different phrasing, keywords, or constraints to guide the AI towards more relevant and insightful responses.
- **Iterate:** Repeat the steps above for multiple rounds, progressively refining the prompt and comparing the AI's outputs.

- **Group Discussion:** Share the evolution of prompts and AI responses with the larger group. Discuss the strategies used to improve the prompts and the impact on the quality of insights.

AI-Powered Insights (Activity 2): Dive deep into user data with the help of AI! Analyze real user interviews or feedback to identify key themes and sentiment. Attendees will critically examine the AI's findings, comparing them to their own analysis to uncover potential biases and limitations.

Steps:

- **AI Analysis:** Input user data into the AI tool. Use prompts to analyze sentiment, identify key themes, or summarize findings.
- **Critical Evaluation:** Compare the AI's output to their own analysis of the data. Identify potential biases, inconsistencies, or areas where the AI may have missed crucial information.
- **Refine and Discuss:** Experiment with refining prompts to improve AI's output. Discuss observations and insights with the group, focusing on the strengths and limitations of AI assistance in UX research.